

CHAPTER TWELVE

UNDER CONTRACT

Let's pretend for a minute that we didn't just spend an entire chapter scaring you about your home inspection. Rewind a few pages to where you are making an offer on a home you like.

If you're in a seller's market, you've probably made a couple of offers already. Those offers were rejected. You got your hopes up, and they came crashing back down. And just when you're thinking you read an entire book about buying a house for nothing—and those crazy authors had *no* idea what they were talking about—you get a call from your agent.

Must be another rejection, you think. It's like being picked for a dodgeball team all over again. You pretended you were fine with being picked last back then, and you will pretend you're fine with it now.

Instead, your agent tells you that your offer was accepted. You can hardly believe your ears.

You are now—drumroll—under contract!

Your agent will guide you through this entire process, so there's no need to be intimidated. You should, however, be proactively informed about all the steps you will encounter. Everything needs to be completed within a fairly short time frame—usually only thirty to forty-five days from this point to closing—which means there's little time to waste during the process.

Because there are so many steps involved, here's an overview of what you'll do from contract to closing, all of which we'll cover in this chapter:

- Let your lender know you're under contract
- Schedule an inspection
- Keep track of your dates
- Read HOA documents (if applicable)
- Deposit earnest money (safely)
- Choose an insurance company